



PARAM PRASAD CHARITABLE SOCIETY'S
SAINT JOSEPH'S ENGLISH MEDIUM SCHOOL

Together in Pursuit of Excellence

Affiliated to CBSE, New Delhi (Affi. No. 1130321)

66/Gattachiwadi Near Latur Kurduwadi Bypass, Agalegaon Road, Barshi- 413401

Tel: 02184-225745, 9763737007



Antarctica Information

Antarctica is Earth's southernmost and least-populated continent, situated almost entirely south of the Antarctic Circle and surrounded by the Southern Ocean. It's the fifth-largest continent, covering about 14.2 million square kilometers (5.5 million square miles).

Geography and Climate:

- Dominated by ice, with 98% of its landmass buried under the Antarctic ice sheet, which averages 1.9 kilometers (1.2 miles) in thickness
- Home to the highest peak, Vinson Massif, and the lowest point, Denman Glacier
- Characterized by extreme cold, dryness, and windiness, making it the coldest, driest, and windiest continent
- Receives limited precipitation, classifying it as a polar desert

Unique Features:

- Largest freshwater reserve, with about 70% of the world's freshwater frozen in its ice sheet
- Home to unique and adapted wildlife, such as penguins, seals, and tardigrades
- Features subglacial lakes, like Lake Vostok, and extensive ice shelves and glaciers
- A prime location for astronomical observations due to its dry climate and lack of light pollution

Research and Governance:

- No permanent human population, but hosts numerous research stations operated by various countries
- Governed by the Antarctic Treaty, which promotes international cooperation and scientific research while protecting the continent's ecosystem
- Territorial claims made by seven countries, but not universally recognized

Interesting Facts:

- Antarctica is home to several active volcanoes, including Mount Erebus and Deception Island
- The continent's ice sheet contains about 90% of the world's total ice volume and 70% of its freshwater
- Antarctica's average ice mass change since 2002 has been on the order of 100 billion metric tons per year
- The continent's extreme cold conditions allow polar stratospheric clouds to form, which contribute to ozone depletion

Wildlife and Vegetation:

- Home to several species of penguins, seals, and other wildlife adapted to the extreme climate
- Supports limited vegetation, including mosses, liverworts, lichens, and two species of flowering plants: Antarctic hair grass and Antarctic pearlwort

Scientific Research:

- Antarctica provides a unique environment for scientific research, including astronomy, geology, and biology
- Scientists study the continent's ice cores, glaciers, and wildlife to gain insights into climate change and the Earth's history.

